

Bethany Thomas

KYC & Compliance Specialist · Front-End Developer · Data Analyst
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

FCA-regulated compliance and KYC specialist with 2+ years at Starling Bank, processing high-volume personal and business onboarding, AML, sanctions screening, and financial crime detection. Pairs regulatory depth with hands-on front-end development (React, TypeScript, Vite) and data skills (Python, R) gained through multiple live deployed projects, including commercial client work. Actively upskilling into full-stack development — currently expanding into SQL and backend engineering to complement existing front-end and Supabase experience. Holds a 2:1 BSc Econ from Cardiff University and a DataCamp Associate Data Analyst Certification. Seeking roles where compliance expertise, technical ability, and analytical rigour intersect.

CORE SKILLS

Compliance & Financial Crime: KYC, EDD, AML, FCA Guidelines, GDPR, Sanctions & PEP Screening, SIRA, CIFAS, Fraud Detection, UBO Identification, Adverse Media, Risk Frameworks, QA
Front-End Development: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Vite, Responsive Design, Accessibility (A11y), Semantic HTML
Back-End & Data: Supabase, REST APIs, Python, R, Statistical Analysis, Data Wrangling — actively learning SQL and backend development
Tools: Git, GitHub, VS Code, Vercel, GitHub Pages, CI/CD pipelines, Adobe Creative Cloud, DaVinci Resolve

WORK EXPERIENCE

Starling Bank · Onboarding Associate

Aug 2023 – Present · Remote

- Processed KYC and Enhanced Due Diligence for thousands of personal and business clients, maintaining full compliance with FCA, AML, GDPR, Sanctions and PEP requirements across a sustained high-volume caseload — zero compliance failures recorded.
- Identified and escalated fraud and financial crime indicators via SIRA and CIFAS, directly reducing risk exposure for Starling's onboarding pipeline while sustaining rigorous QA standards.
- Produced complex corporate ownership analyses and written risk assessments on high-risk client profiles, enabling senior reviewers to reach faster, better-evidenced decisions.
- Worked cross-functionally with operations to map and fix workflow bottlenecks in the onboarding journey, reducing customer drop-off while maintaining strict regulatory compliance.
- Maintained GDPR-compliant data handling end-to-end across the client lifecycle, building information governance habits directly transferable to engineering and software environments.

McDonald's · Crew Trainer

Jan 2023 – Aug 2023 · Cardiff

- Trained and signed off new team members on operational procedures and service standards, improving onboarding speed and consistency in a high-throughput environment.
- Maintained HACCP food safety compliance and operated EPOS and digital ordering systems, consistently exceeding speed and accuracy targets.

PROJECTS

Personal Portfolio Website · HTML5, CSS3, Vanilla JavaScript, GitHub Pages, GitHub Actions

[Live site](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Intentionally framework-free personal portfolio at gekkzzz.co.uk — built with plain HTML, CSS, and vanilla JavaScript, no build step required, demonstrating confident use of web fundamentals without relying on frameworks.

- Features a custom GitHub activity calendar renderer, live dual-clock with timezone detection and IP-based location enrichment, Substack RSS blog feed, GDPR-compliant cookie consent system, and a hidden retro Pong game.
- Deployed via GitHub Actions CI/CD to GitHub Pages; every push to main triggers an automated deploy with zero manual steps.

Apple-Inspired Responsive Website · *TypeScript, CSS3, HTML5, Vite, Vercel*

[Live site](#) · [GitHub](#)

- Built a fully responsive, high-performance site inspired by Apple’s minimalist design language using TypeScript and Vite, with vanilla CSS3 for precise layout and styling control.
- Achieved strong Core Web Vitals scores through optimised asset loading, semantic HTML5, and A11y best practices; deployed via Vercel CI/CD pipeline.

Tape ‘N’ Torque — Client Portfolio Website · *React, JavaScript, CSS3, HTML5, Vite, Vercel*

[Live site](#)

- Designed and built a professional portfolio website for a real client using React 18 and Vite, with custom CSS3 styling and a fully responsive, mobile-first layout.
- Managed the full project lifecycle independently — from client brief through UI design, build, and deployment via Vercel CI/CD. Project is complete and live; the client has opted not to purchase a custom domain at this stage.

Bite With Taz — Food Blog (In Progress) · *React, JavaScript, CSS3, HTML5, Vite, Vercel*

[Live site \(preview\)](#)

- Currently building a food blog site for a content creator client using React and Vite — active work in progress with the client, presently focused on nailing the visual aesthetic and brand feel before building out the full blog functionality.
- Deployed to Vercel as a live preview environment, giving the client a real-time view of design iterations throughout the process.

Welsh Senedd Political Matcher · *Web, Data Handling, Front-End*

Swansea University Hackathon · Team Project · 2020–2022

- Built a civic tech web app under competition conditions that matched voters to their most aligned Welsh political party based on policy preferences — combining data handling, user input logic and front-end presentation.

EDUCATION

Cardiff University · BSc Econ International Relations & Politics — 2:1 Sep 2022 – Jul 2025 · *Cardiff*

- Relevant modules: quantitative research methods, statistical analysis, international law, political economy, global governance — applied using Python and R for data-driven policy analysis.
- Co-founded Stronger Together student service — Secretary & Treasurer; awarded Cardiff University Student Led Service of the Year.
- Elected Student Senator, Accessibility Officer (Cardiff Students Union), and Vice-President of Labour Students Society.

Coleg Sir Gâr · A Levels

2019 – 2022 · Llanelli

- Law — A (Student of the Year, Highest Grade in Cohort) · Sociology — A · Welsh Baccalaureate — A · Government & Politics — B
- Elected Wellbeing Officer across all Coleg Sir Gâr campuses.

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- DataCamp Associate Data Analyst Certification — applied through Python/R data wrangling and statistical analysis in university coursework
- Cardiff University: Student Led Service of the Year — Stronger Together
- Cardiff University: Contribution to Student Voice Award
- Coleg Sir Gâr: Student of the Year in Law — Highest Grade in Cohort